A Fibonacci Spine in a Five-fold Chorus of Ogdoecontahedron Packings

Five periodic packings of one icosahedral solid meet round a five-fold axis; the copies that must be removed along the axis form, exactly, the canonical Fibonacci cut-and-project chain, its window fixed by a five-fold ring clashing with itself, until height 12.8, where minimal removal thins it

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DICTO DOI: on publication · Licence CC BY 4.0 · Data, scripts, exact checks and renders: https://github.com/DICTOR-Master/kaleidohedra (branch research, studies/2026-10-16-ocd-pyrochlore, steps 17–29).

The Ogdoecontahedron, its pyrochlore attachment networks, the five-fold "frog chorus" of five voices, and the questions that led to the exact chorus, its boundary, the shape of its core and the fork are DICTO's. Computation, exact arithmetic, renders and the literature search were done with Claude (Anthropic) as a research assistant; one bounded literature review was done with Claude Fable.

Abstract. The DICTO Ogdoecontahedron is a convex icosahedral solid with 20 regular hexagons and 60 kites. Its hexagon directions contain five inscribed cubes, and each cube gives a periodic packing in which copies meet face to face on hexagons. We place the five packings ("voices") in five 72° wedges round a five-fold axis, which is the icosahedral irrational twin, and remove clashing copies in whole five-fold rings. Checked exactly in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$, the result is overlap-free to radius 10 (2756 sites, 385 removed, 7465 close pairs). Every copy lies at a golden height $(m + n\varphi)u$ along the axis. The copies removed near the axis lie in one plane on a rank-2 lattice with axis slope $-\varphi$, and they are exactly the canonical singular Fibonacci cut-and-project chain, window $[0, L)$ with $L^2 = 64/81 + 128\sqrt{5}/405$, the central copy being one of its points. The window has a mechanism: a ring of five copies overlaps itself exactly when it is closer to the axis than t_c, $t_c^2 = 8/9 + 8\sqrt{5}/45$. Since $t_c < L$ and no lattice point lies between them below height 12.81, the chain is exactly Fibonacci there. At height 12.81, the first such point, the core copy overlaps exactly one other copy, which also overlaps a third; removing that other copy is cheaper by one ring than removing the core copy, here and at the next three such points. Minimal removal therefore keeps the core copy and thins the spine to a three-gap chain; staying pure Fibonacci costs one extra ring at each such point. Irrational interfaces as one-dimensional quasicrystals, model sets near irrational lines and hard-core windows are known; we did not find this selection along a five-fold junction line, its self-clash window or the departure from it, and present them as a new exact instance of known ideas.

1. Introduction

Periodic crystals repeat; quasicrystals are ordered without repeating, and can be described as cuts through higher-dimensional lattices. Between the two lie twinned crystals. When grains of one crystal meet at an irrational orientation, the interface between them can itself be a one-dimensional quasicrystal (Sutton 1988, 1989, 1992; Rivier & Lawrence 1988; Gratias & Thalal 1988), and five cubic variants turned by 72° about an irrational axis form the icosahedral irrational twin, whose coincidence-lattice approximants stack in Fibonacci order

(Ranganathan, Srivastava & Lord 2006). Pauling (1985) proposed, wrongly, that icosahedral quasicrystals are multiply twinned cubic crystals; Prodan et al. (2017) describe icosahedral tilings as cyclic twinning of golden rhombohedra.

This paper follows one solid through such a twin, exactly. Five periodic packings of the DICTO Ogdoecontahedron meet round a five-fold axis. Hard copies cannot overlap, so some must be removed ("silenced"). We show that the copies removed along the axis are not merely quasiperiodic but are exactly the canonical Fibonacci chain, that the window comes from a five-fold ring of copies clashing with itself, and that beyond a height of 12.81 minimal removal departs from the Fibonacci chain.

Every statement is labelled. **Exact** means proved or checked in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$ with rational arithmetic; **float** means computed in floating point and not proved.

2. The solid

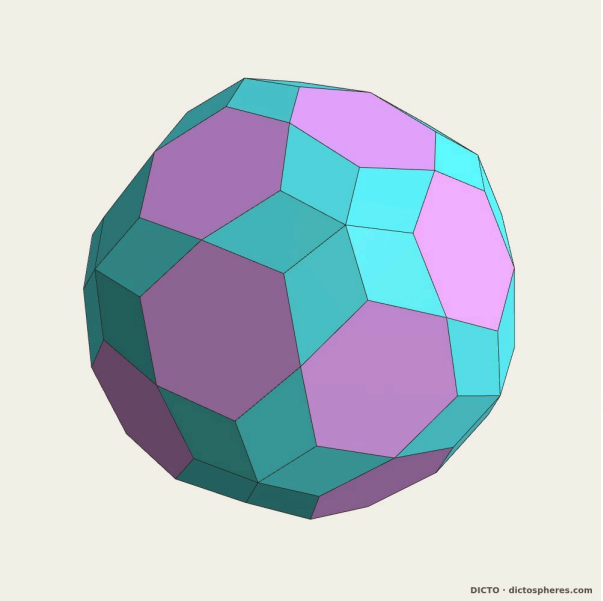


Fig. 1. The DICTO Ogdoecontahedron: 20 regular hexagons and 60 kites.

The DICTO Ogdoecontahedron (DICTO's companion paper, in draft) is the polar reciprocal of the DICTO Truncated-Icosahedral Hecatodihedron (DICTO DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23360858), and the second station of the Spheres of Dharma turned inside out (DICTO DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23310833). It has 80 faces (20 regular hexagons, 60 kites with angles 117.85°, 68.62°, 55.69°), 102 corners (12 of degree 5, 30 of degree 4, 60 of degree 3) and 180 edges. All coordinates are exact in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$. It is not canonical: its edges lie at two distances from the centre, so it has no midsphere.

Face arrangement (exact). An exact face-map comparison (mirror images allowed, with positive and negative controls) shows that its face arrangement is that of the pentakis dodecahedron with its 20 six-fold corners cut down to the edge midpoints, equivalently the dual of L0(D), the joined-lace dodecahedron in Antiprism's operator notation. The arrangement is therefore obtainable by standard operations. It is not, however, in David McCooey's *Visual Polyhedra*, whose 553 solids we scanned in full; its nearest relative there is the 6-truncated pentakis dodecahedron (20 hexagons, 60 pentagons), whose truncation ends, at the edge midpoints, in this arrangement. The printed catalogues (Wenninger, Holden,

Pugh) were ruled out by scope, not read. The metric solid, with regular hexagons and these kites, was not found in any source checked.

3. Five voices and the chorus

Bonds and cubes (exact). Joining two copies face to face on a hexagon, with no rotation, displaces one by the bond vector $2d \cdot n/|n|^2$ of that hexagon (n its normal, d its plane offset). The 20 hexagon directions contain exactly five sets of eight that form a cube (pairwise cosines $\pm 1/3$ and -1): the five inscribed cubes. Each cube's bond vectors generate a rank-3 lattice, and copies on it meet face to face on hexagons, with joints on a pyrochlore lattice. These five periodic packings are the five **voices**.

The chorus. Fix a five-fold axis through a degree-5 corner of the central copy. Space is cut into five 72° wedges round the axis (starting angle 59°, a choice), and wedge k is filled with voice k's lattice points; points on the axis are shared. Turning by 72° about the axis carries each voice to the next, so the arrangement is five-fold symmetric. Neighbouring voices are related by 44.4775° about a shared three-fold axis: this is the icosahedral irrational twin (Ranganathan et al. 2006). Where wedges meet, and near the axis, copies of different voices overlap. They are removed in whole five-fold rings by a greedy rule (float clash test): repeatedly remove the ring of the copy with most clashes, ties going to the copy farther from the centre.

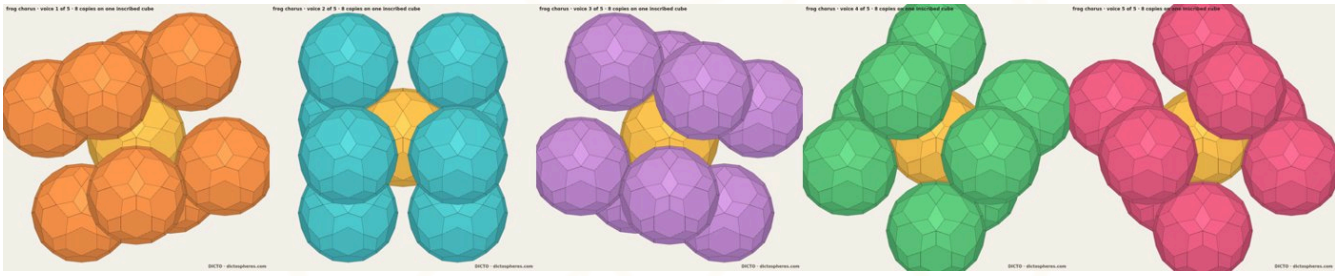
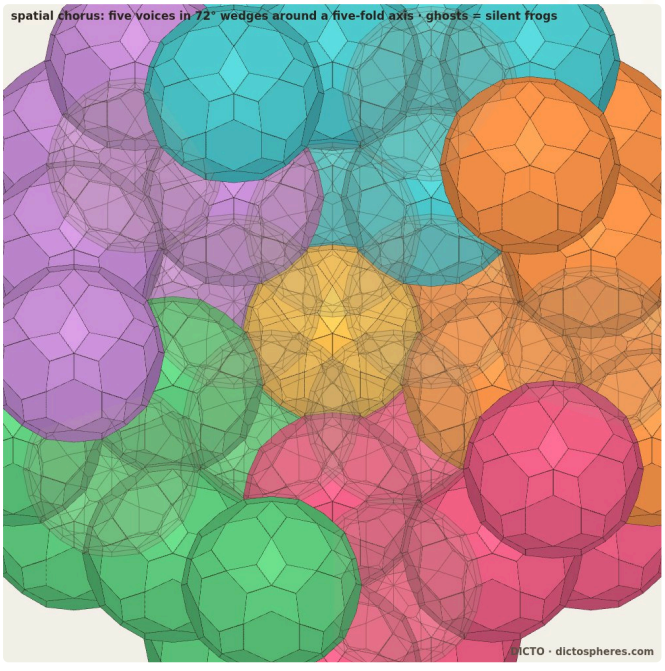


Fig. 2. The five voices: on each inscribed cube, eight copies joined face to face on hexagons round a central copy.



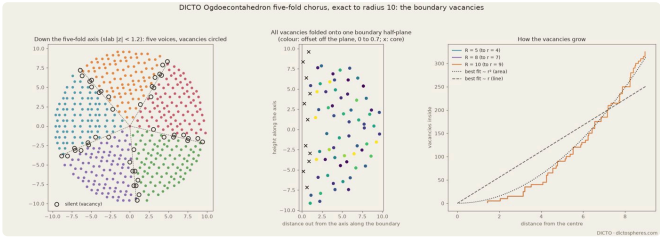


Fig. 3–4. (3) The chorus down the five-fold axis, voices in five colours, removed copies as ghosts (small early build). (4) The radius-10 build: vacancies circled; vacancies folded onto one boundary half-plane; growth of the vacancy count with radius.

4. Exactness

Two copies at X and Y are apart if and only if some face plane $n \cdot x = d$ of the solid has $n \cdot (X - Y) \geq 2d$ (the difference body of a centrally symmetric solid K is 2K); they touch when the best face gives equality. Copies farther apart than twice the circumradius cannot overlap, so checking every closer pair is complete. All positions are integer combinations of exact bond vectors.

Radius	Sites	Removed	Close pairs checked	Overlaps	Touching
5	336	80	620	0	620
8	1471	240	3630	0	3605
10	2756	385	7465	0	7390

The choice of what to remove is float; the result is exact. At radius 5 an integer program (float clash test) finds the minimal five-fold-symmetric removal to be 16 rings (80 copies), the same as the greedy rule, and not unique; without symmetry the minimum is 72.

Lemma (golden heights, exact). Measured along the five-fold axis, every bond vector has height $(m + n\varphi)u$ with $u^2 = 8/81 - 8\sqrt{5}/405$ ($u \approx 0.233658$), the pairs (m, n) being only $(\pm 1, 0)$ and $\pm(1, 2)$. Every site is an integer combination of bonds, so **every copy in the chorus, at any radius, sits at a golden height $(m + n\varphi)u$.**

5. The core is the canonical Fibonacci chain

Near the axis the removals come in rings of five, one copy per wedge. In the radius-10 build there are 11 such rings. Their squared distances from the axis include φ^2, φ^4, φ^6 and φ^8 times the innermost (exact).

One plane, one lattice, one window (exact). Ten of the 11 rings have their wedge-0 copy in one plane through the axis. The 73 sites of that plane in the build are integer combinations of two basis vectors, and in that basis the axis has slope $-\varphi = -1/2 - \sqrt{5}/2$, which is irrational, so heights along the axis are all distinct. With t the distance across from the axis, the removed plane copies are exactly those with t below a window edge: there is no kept copy inside and no removed copy outside. Lattice points of a planar lattice in a strip along an irrational line are, by definition, a cut-and-project (model) set (Baake & Grimm 2013).

The canonical window (exact). The gaps between consecutive removed heights take the values S = 1.22345, L = 1.97958 and T = 3.20304, with $L/S = \varphi$ and $T = L + S$ exactly; the gap vectors of L and S have plane coordinates $(1, -1)$ and $(1, 0)$, a lattice basis. The canonical window length is therefore $L_{can}^2 = 64/81 + 128\sqrt{5}/405$ ($L_{can} = 1.223451$), and the single T is where the chain point at height 0, the **central copy**, sits (on the axis, t = 0, kept). With window $[0, L_{can})$, the chain points inside the build are exactly the 11 removed copies and the centre; the copy exactly on the far edge ($t = L_{can}$, height -0.756) is kept. Extended exactly to heights ± 45, the same window gives 54 points with only two gaps in ratio φ (33 long, 20 short) forming a factor of the Fibonacci word. Both window edges are lattice points: the chain is a **singular** member of the Fibonacci family, with the centre on the closed edge.

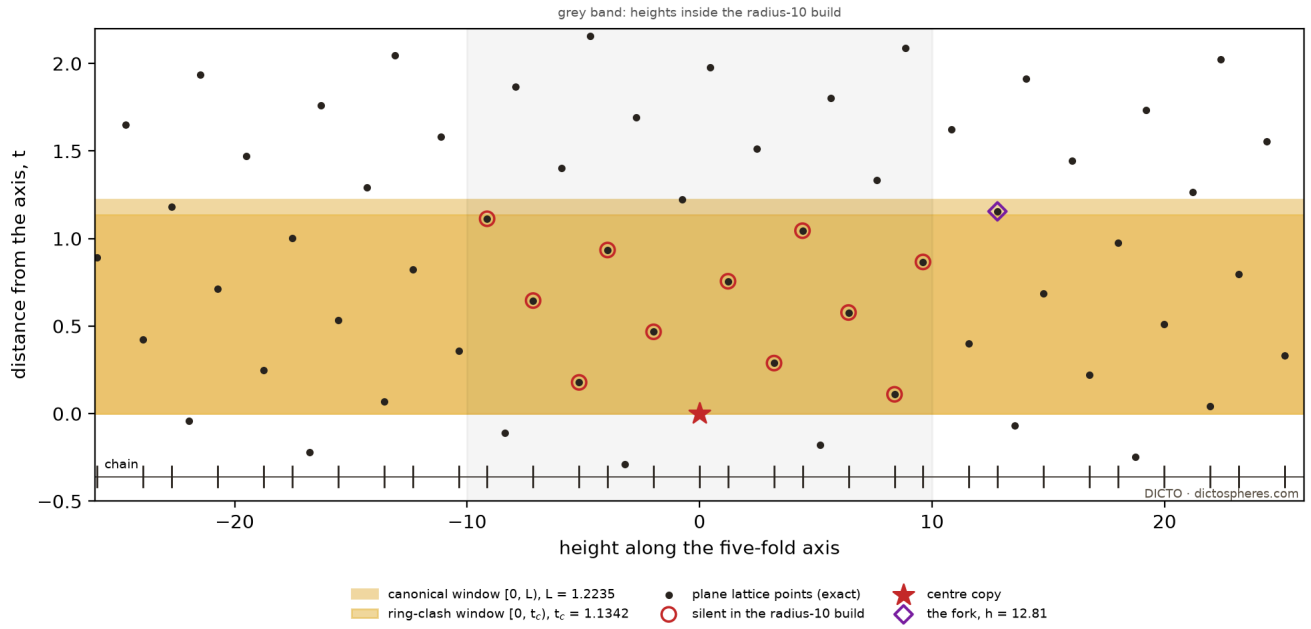


Fig. 5. The core plane as a cut-and-project picture (exact points, drawn in float). Dots: plane lattice points by height along the axis and distance t from it. Circled: removed in the radius-10 build (grey band). Pale band: canonical window [0, L); darker band: ring-clash window [0, t_c). Star: the central copy. Diamond: the fork at height 12.81. Ticks below: the canonical chain.

6. Why that window: the ring clashes with itself

A copy at distance t from the axis and its four ring-mates (the same copy turned by 72°k, sites of the other voices) differ by vectors perpendicular to the axis and proportional to t. So whether a ring overlaps itself depends on t alone. Checked exactly for every plane copy with t < 1.6: each removed copy overlaps its ring-mates, each kept one clears them. The critical distance, where ring-mates just touch, is exact and the same for every plane site:

$$\mathbf{t_c^2 = 8/9 + 8\sqrt{5}/45, \quad t_c = 1.134201.}$$

It lies strictly between the largest removed t (1.113132) and L_{can} (1.223451); the copy on the canonical edge clears its ring-mates by $28/81 - 4\sqrt{5}/27 \approx 0.014$ (best face separation). So $t_c \neq L_{can}$, and hardness alone gives the narrower window [0, t_c). No plane lattice point has $t_c \le t < L_{can}$ below height 12.812, so up to there the two windows select the same points and **the core is exactly the canonical Fibonacci chain, beyond the build's own reach (|h| < 10)**. The first lattice points between the two windows are at heights 12.812, −22.71, 34.77 and −44.66.

7. The fork at height 12.81

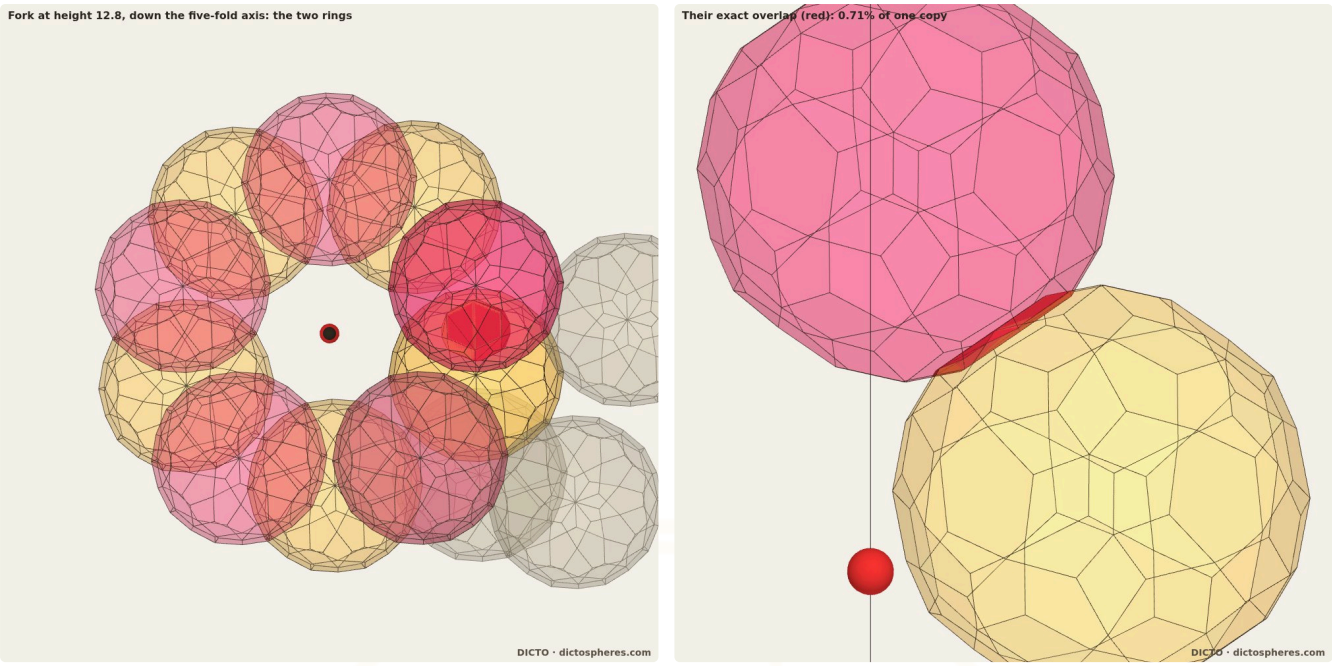


Fig. 6–7. (6) Down the axis: the ring through the core copy at height 12.81 (gold) and the ring at 13.80 (magenta); red, where a gold and a magenta copy overlap. (7) Close-up: the exact overlap, a thin sliver of 0.71% of one copy (float volume). A supplementary movie shows both choices.

We built every site of all five voices in a cylinder round the axis at that height (1135 sites; exact). The core copy at height 12.8121 (t = 1.1553, plane coordinates (8, −4)) clears all four ring-mates, as §6 predicts. Of the seven copies near enough to matter, it overlaps **exactly one**, its *rival*: a copy at height 13.8019, distance 1.1690 from the axis, in the next wedge, outside the core plane, whose own ring does not clash with itself. The deepest face separation between the two is $232/81 - 104\sqrt{5}/81 \approx -0.0068$ (exact, negative: overlap). The rival overlaps two further copies (exact): a core-plane copy at height 14.79 that is removed in any case, and a copy at height 14.04, distance 1.91 from the axis, whose ring does not clash with itself.

So the clash can be resolved in two ways:

- **remove the rival's ring**: this also settles its clash with the copy at 14.04; the core copy stays, height 12.81 leaves the chain, and the spine becomes a thinned chain with gaps L, S and L + S;
- **remove the core ring**: height 12.81 joins the chain and the spine stays Fibonacci, but the rival's clash with the copy at 14.04 remains and costs a second ring.

Minimal removal (integer program over whole rings, float clash test, on patches of about 1130–1155 sites). At each of the first four points where the two windows disagree (heights 12.81, −22.71, 34.77, −44.66) the pattern is the same, and keeping the core copy is cheaper by exactly one ring (43 against 44, 46 against 47, 45 against 46 and 42 against 43). The chorus's greedy rule agrees: the rival has two live clashes to the core copy's one, so it is removed first. **Hardness with minimal removal therefore departs from the Fibonacci chain at height 12.81**, and as far as checked follows the narrower ring-clash window $[0, t_c)$: a thinned three-gap cut-and-project chain. Pure Fibonacci can be kept, for instance by removing first the ring nearest to clashing with itself, but that rule removes 555 copies

instead of 385 in the radius-10 build; it costs one extra ring at every departure point. Either way the spine remains a one-dimensional cut-and-project chain.

8. The seams (float)

Away from the axis, removals lie along the five wedge boundaries. Their number grows like area, not length (5, 20, 60, 95, 145, 205 and 275 within radius 3 to 9), and their density per boundary area is still rising at radius 9 (0.31 to 0.43 from radius 5 to 9). The distance from the seam plane does not decide which copies go: kept and removed copies share offsets on both sides, so there is no simple slab rule. The 66 distinct vacancies of one seam diffract strongly: strongest peak I/N = 46.6, against 66 for a perfect Bragg peak and 11.8 ± 2.0 for random sets of the same size, with the strongest peaks within the peak width of projected reciprocal-lattice vectors of the two neighbouring voices. This is consistent with incommensurate, quasiperiodic-type order, but 66 points cannot tell it from a long-period approximant.

9. Discussion

Relation to known work. That interfaces between periodic grains can be one-dimensional quasicrystals is classical (Sutton; Gratias & Thalal; Rivier & Lawrence), as is the fact that lattice points near an irrational line form a model set (Baake & Grimm 2013). Katz & Gratias (1993) bounded icosahedral windows by hard-core and closeness conditions: there the window is *chosen* to maximise density inside a six-dimensional model, and exclusion acts between points one lattice shift apart. Here nothing is chosen: the removed set is the window, forced by overlap, and the exclusion acts between a copy and its own five-fold rotated images, which belong to four other periodic packings. One-dimensional lattice gases have Sturmian (cut-and-project) ground states (Hubbard 1978; van Enter, Koivusalo & Miękisz 2019), a related selection by energy rather than by shape.

Not a disclination. Five-fold twinned particles (fivelings) carry a wedge disclination along their axis, with an angle gap relieved by strain or defects (Hofmeister 1998). The chorus has no gap and no strain; its axis is a line of irrational direction shared by five lattices, and the price of five-fold symmetry is paid in vacancies. Hard shapes are known to form five-fold twinned clusters in simulation (Lee & Glotzer 2022), in floating point and with an angle gap; we know of no exact junction check for a hard polyhedron.

What we did not find. A Fibonacci chain *along* a five-fold junction line rather than across a planar interface; a window fixed by a ring clashing with itself, with an exact critical distance; an exact overlap check of a five-fold junction of hard-polyhedron packings; minimal removal departing from the canonical window to a narrower one. The search covered our reference library, the web and one bounded literature review (§11). Several key papers are closed access and were read through abstracts and open restatements only; we present the results as a new exact instance of known ideas and make no claim of priority.

Limits. The packing is checked to radius 10 and the departure points on patches of about 1130–1155 sites, the first four only; the choice of removals and the integer programs use a float clash test (the clashes at 12.81 are confirmed exactly); the seams are float throughout; the off-plane ring at distance 1.0042 from the axis belongs to a second family not analysed here.

10. Open questions

- Does minimal removal follow the ring-clash window $[0, t_c)$ at every height, making the spine exactly the thinned cut-and-project chain of that window?
- Are the seams model sets, and is their density per area finite in the limit?
- What is the off-plane family of core rings?
- Which other solids have five inscribed cubes in their bond directions, and do their choruses give other chains?

11. Reproducibility

Scripts and outputs are in studies/2026-10-16-ocd-pyrochlore of the Kaleidohedra repository (branch research): `chorus_exact_big.py` (the exact chorus, any radius), `chorus_heights_exact.py` (§4), `chorus_modelset.py` and `chorus_canonical.py` (§5), `chorus_window_why.py` (§6), `chorus_h128.py`, `chorus_fork_data.py`, `chorus_rules.py`, `chorus_fork_min.py` and `chorus_fork_exact2.py` (§7), `chorus_boundary.py` (§8), `ocd_dl0d.py` and `ocd_catalogue_scan.py` (§2), each with its output in data/. The literature review is `FABLE-PRIORART.md`. Movies of the boundary sweep and of the fork are supplementary.

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